APPLICATION TO EXTEND NONIMMIGRANT STATUS

Form I-539
B-2 Tourist Visa Extension

Applicant: MARIA HELENA RODRIGUES COSTA

Passport: BR789456123

Current Status: B-2 (Tourist)

Extension Until: 12/13/2025

PRIMARY REASON:
Medical Treatment and Recovery

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TAB A - COVER LETTER

November 21, 2025

U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services
California Service Center
P.O. Box 10539
Laguna Niguel, CA 92607-1053

RE: Form I-539 - Application to Extend Nonimmigrant Status
Applicant: MARIA HELENA RODRIGUES COSTA
Date of Birth: April 15, 1965
Passport: BR789456123
I-94: 94123456789012

Dear USCIS Officer:

I. INTRODUCTION

I, MARIA HELENA RODRIGUES COSTA, a 59-year-old citizen of Brazil, respectfully submit this Form I-539 application to extend my B-2 visitor status. I entered the United States on 12/15/2024 through Miami International Airport (MIA) and my current authorization expires on 06/13/2025. This application is being filed 24 days before expiration, demonstrating timely and responsible compliance with U.S. immigration procedures.

II. PURPOSE OF EXTENSION

I am requesting an extension until 12/13/2025 (180 days) due to unexpected and serious medical circumstances that arose during my visit. On March 10, 2025, I experienced a severe cardiac emergency requiring immediate hospitalization and surgical intervention. Following cardiac catheterization and stent placement at Mount Sinai Medical Center in Miami Beach, Florida, my cardiologist has advised that I require a minimum of six months of post-procedure monitoring, cardiac rehabilitation, and medication adjustment before being medically cleared for international air travel.

This extension request is based solely on medical necessity. I have no intention of remaining in the United States beyond what is medically required, and I am eager to return to my home, family, and life in Brazil as soon as my doctors clear me for travel.

III. DETAILED MEDICAL EMERGENCY

On the evening of March 10, 2025, while visiting my daughter and grandchildren in Miami, I experienced severe chest pain, shortness of breath, and extreme fatigue. Recognizing these symptoms as potentially life-threatening, my daughter immediately transported me to the Emergency Department at Mount Sinai Medical Center.

Emergency Diagnosis and Treatment:
Upon arrival at the Emergency Department, I was evaluated by the cardiology team and diagnosed with acute coronary syndrome. Emergency cardiac catheterization revealed significant blockages in two coronary arteries. On March 12, 2025, Dr. Robert Martinez, MD, FACC (Board-Certified

Interventional Cardiologist), performed an emergency percutaneous coronary intervention (PCI) with placement of two drug-eluting stents.

Current Medical Status:
Following the procedure, I have been under continuous cardiological care, including:
• Weekly cardiology appointments for monitoring
• Cardiac rehabilitation program (3 sessions per week)
• Antiplatelet medication therapy requiring close monitoring
• Regular echocardiograms and stress testing
• Blood work to monitor medication effects

Medical Travel Restrictions:
Dr. Martinez has explicitly advised against international air travel until at least September 2025 due to:
• Risk of thrombosis during long-distance flight
• Need for immediate access to specialized cardiac care
• Requirement for ongoing medication adjustments
• Altitude and cabin pressure concerns during recovery
• Importance of completing full cardiac rehabilitation protocol

Complete medical documentation, including hospital records, physician letters, treatment plans, and medical restrictions, is included in this application package (Tab D and E).

IV. FINANCIAL SELF-SUFFICIENCY

I am entirely self-supporting and will not become a public charge. I have substantial financial resources to cover all expenses during the requested extension period:

Personal Assets:
• Brazilian Bank Account (Banco do Brasil): R$ 485,000 (~$97,000 USD)
• Primary Residence in Belo Horizonte: R$ 1,200,000 (~$240,000 USD)
• Additional Savings and Investments: R$ 150,000 (~$30,000 USD)
• **Total Liquid Assets: $127,000+ USD**

Regular Income:
• Monthly Pension (INSS - Brazil): R$ 8,500 (~$1,700 USD/month)
• Pension will continue throughout my stay in the United States

U.S. Financial Support:
Additionally, my daughter, Ana Paula Costa, a U.S. Citizen and Registered Nurse earning $78,000 annually, is providing housing and supplemental support. I am staying with her family at no cost, significantly reducing my expenses.

Health Insurance Coverage:
• International Travel Health Insurance: Assist Card (Policy AC-BR-2024-789456)
• Coverage Amount: $150,000 USD
• Valid Through: December 31, 2025
• Medical expenses partially covered; balance paid from personal funds

Monthly Budget During Extension:
• Housing: $0 (staying with daughter)
• Food & Groceries: $800
• Transportation: $400
• Medical Copays & Medications: $500
• Personal Expenses: $500
• Miscellaneous: $300
• **Total Monthly Expenses: ~$2,500**

With my monthly pension income of $1,700 and liquid assets exceeding $127,000, I can easily support myself for the requested 6-month extension period (total estimated cost: $15,000). I have not worked, will not work, and have not used any U.S. government benefits or public assistance.

Complete financial documentation is included: 6 months of bank statements, pension income statements, property ownership documents, and my daughter's support letter and financial documents (Tabs F, G, and H).

V. STRONG AND UNBREAKABLE TIES TO BRAZIL

I have extremely strong ties to Brazil that absolutely guarantee my timely return upon medical clearance. My entire life—family, home, financial assets, and community—is in Brazil. I have no ties to the United States beyond this temporary medical situation and my visit with my daughter.

1. Family Ties (Primary and Strongest):
Husband: João Carlos Rodrigues Costa (Age 62, Retired Engineer)
• Married for 35 years
• Currently in Belo Horizonte maintaining our household and property
• We speak daily by phone and video call
• Eagerly awaiting my return

Children:
• Son: Lucas Rodrigues Costa (Age 34, Civil Engineer in São Paulo, Brazil)
• Daughter: Ana Paula Costa (U.S. Citizen, resides in Miami with her family)

Grandchildren in Brazil:
• Multiple grandchildren from my son in São Paulo
• Extended family throughout Minas Gerais

My husband and son in Brazil need me to return. This separation has been extremely difficult for our family. I left Brazil expecting a normal 2-3 month visit with my daughter and grandchildren in Miami. This medical emergency has extended my stay far beyond my original plans, and I am desperate to return home to my husband and the rest of my family in Brazil.

2. Property and Real Estate Ownership:
• **Primary Residence:** Rua das Flores, 245, Apto 801, Belo Horizonte, MG
• Property Value: R$ 1,200,000 (~$240,000 USD)
• Ownership Status: Owned outright (no mortgage)
• Home for 30+ years
• Contains all personal belongings, furniture, and lifetime possessions
• My husband currently maintains the property

3. Financial and Economic Ties:
• All bank accounts in Brazil (Banco do Brasil)
• All investments in Brazilian financial institutions
• Pension received exclusively from Brazil (INSS)
• Brazilian tax resident with annual tax filing obligations
• No financial accounts or assets in the United States
• No employment or business interests in the United States

4. Social, Cultural, and Community Ties:
• Lifetime resident of Belo Horizonte (59 years)
• Active member of local Catholic parish for 40+ years
• Member of senior citizens' social club
• Longtime friendships and neighborhood relationships
• Established medical care team in Brazil (general practitioner, specialists)

• Deep cultural and linguistic connections to Brazil

5. Intent to Return:
I have absolutely no intention or desire to remain in the United States beyond what is medically necessary. My life, my home, my husband, my son, my extended family, my friends, my community, and my 59 years of memories are all in Brazil. This extension request is **solely** to allow safe completion of medical treatment before undertaking the long international flight back to Brazil. The moment my cardiologist clears me for air travel, I will immediately return to Brazil to reunite with my husband and resume my life.

Complete documentation of ties to Brazil is included in this package (Tab I), including property deeds, family documentation, photographs, and letters from family members in Brazil.

VI. PERFECT IMMIGRATION COMPLIANCE HISTORY

I have maintained perfect compliance with U.S. immigration laws throughout my history of visiting the United States:

Previous U.S. Visits:
• **Visit #1 (2023):** Entry: July 10, 2023 | Departure: September 5, 2023 | Duration: 57 days
Purpose: Tourism and family visit | Status: Departed on time

• **Visit #2 (2022-2023):** Entry: December 20, 2022 | Departure: January 15, 2023 | Duration: 26 days
Purpose: Holiday family visit | Status: Departed on time

Current Visit (2024-2025):
• Entry: December 15, 2024
• Authorized Until: June 13, 2025
• Current Duration: Approximately 5 months (within authorization)
• Filing Date: May 20, 2025 (24 days before expiration)
• Status: TIMELY - Filed well before current status expires

Compliance Record Summary:
• Total Previous Visits: 2
• Total Previous Time in U.S.: 83 days
• Overstays: NONE
• Immigration Violations: NONE
• Timely Departures: 100% (2 out of 2 visits)
• Current Application: Filed BEFORE expiration (Timely)

Visa Validity:
• B-2 Visa Number: B2-98765432
• Issue Date: November 5, 2023
• Expiration Date: November 4, 2033 (10-year visa)
• Status: VALID

This perfect compliance record demonstrates my consistent respect for U.S. immigration laws and my reliability in adhering to visa conditions. I have always departed the United States voluntarily and on time, and I will continue to maintain this perfect record by departing immediately upon completion of medical treatment and receiving travel clearance from my physician.

Complete travel history documentation, including passport stamps, previous I-94 records, and departure records, is included in this package (Tab J).

VII. COMPREHENSIVE DOCUMENTATION ENCLOSED

This application package contains complete and comprehensive documentation to support the extension request:

A. Core Application Documents:
• Form I-539 (Application to Extend/Change Nonimmigrant Status) - Completed
• Filing Fee: $370.00 (payment included)
• This cover letter
• Personal statement from applicant

B. Identification and Status Documents:
• Passport biographical page (certified copy)
• Current U.S. B-2 visa (certified copy)
• Form I-94 Arrival/Departure Record (official printout)
• Passport-style photographs (2)

C. Medical Documentation (Extensive):
• Hospital admission and discharge records (Mount Sinai Medical Center)
• Cardiac catheterization procedure report
• Stent placement medical records
• Letter from Dr. Robert Martinez, MD, FACC (Treating Cardiologist)
• Medical treatment plan and schedule
• Travel restriction letter from physician
• Cardiac rehabilitation program documentation
• Prescription medication list and monitoring requirements
• Follow-up appointment schedule
• Medical clearance requirements for international travel

D. Financial Evidence (Comprehensive):
• Bank statements from Banco do Brasil (6 months: Oct 2024 - March 2025)
• Pension income statements (INSS - Brazil)
• Property ownership documents (deed for primary residence in Belo Horizonte)
• Property valuation documentation
• Affidavit of Support from U.S. citizen daughter (Form I-134 style)
• Daughter's employment verification and income documentation
• International health insurance policy (Assist Card - $150,000 coverage)
• Monthly budget and expense documentation

E. Ties to Brazil Documentation:
• Marriage certificate (certified translation)
• Property deed for primary residence in Brazil
• Family photographs (husband, children, grandchildren in Brazil)
• Letters from husband and son in Brazil
• Community organization membership documentation
• Church membership letter
• Brazilian tax returns (demonstrating tax residency)

• Utility bills for Brazilian residence

F. Travel History and Compliance:
• Previous passport stamps (entries and departures)
• Previous I-94 records showing timely departures
• Travel itineraries from previous visits
• Return flight tickets from previous visits (showing compliance)
• International travel history to other countries

G. Supporting Letters:
• Letter from U.S. citizen daughter (Ana Paula Costa)
• Letter from husband in Brazil (João Carlos Rodrigues Costa)
• Letter from son in Brazil (Lucas Rodrigues Costa)
• Letter from treating physician (Dr. Robert Martinez, MD)

Each document is organized by tab, clearly labeled, and accompanied by English translations where applicable. This package represents a complete, thorough, and fully documented application demonstrating compelling reasons for the extension, strong ties to Brazil, financial self-sufficiency, and perfect immigration compliance.

VIII. CONCLUSION AND RESPECTFUL REQUEST

This extension request is based on genuine, documented, and unavoidable medical circumstances that arose unexpectedly during what was intended to be a routine family visit. I did not anticipate or plan for a serious cardiac emergency requiring emergency surgery and extended recovery.

Summary of Key Points:

1. Medical Necessity: The extension is required solely for completion of post-cardiac procedure monitoring and rehabilitation. International air travel is medically contraindicated until treatment completion. Medical documentation from a Board-Certified Cardiologist confirms this necessity.

2. Financial Independence: I possess substantial personal financial resources ($127,000+ in liquid assets, $1,700/month pension income) and have comprehensive health insurance. I will not work, seek employment, or use public benefits. I am entirely self-sufficient.

3. Strong Ties to Brazil: Every aspect of my life is rooted in Brazil—my husband of 35 years, my son, my home (owned outright, valued at $240,000), all financial assets, my pension, my community, and 59 years of relationships and memories. I have no ties to the United States beyond my daughter's family and this temporary medical situation.

4. Perfect Compliance: I have maintained 100% compliance with U.S. immigration laws across all previous visits, always departing voluntarily and on time. This application was filed timely, 24 days before expiration, demonstrating continued respect for immigration procedures.

5. Temporary Nature: This extension is explicitly temporary and medically-driven. Upon receiving medical clearance for international travel (expected September 2025), I will immediately return to Brazil to reunite with my husband and resume my life.

6. No Immigrant Intent: I have no intention, desire, or reason to remain in the United States permanently. At age 59, with a loving husband, family, home, and established life in Brazil, my only wish is to complete necessary medical treatment and return home as quickly and safely as possible.

Request to USCIS:
I respectfully request that U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services grant this extension of B-2 visitor status until December 13, 2025, to allow completion of essential medical treatment and safe return to Brazil. This extension will enable me to:
• Complete cardiac rehabilitation under medical supervision
• Obtain medical clearance for international air travel
• Safely return to my husband, family, and life in Brazil
• Maintain my perfect record of immigration compliance

I am deeply grateful for USCIS consideration of this application. I understand the importance of maintaining the integrity of U.S. immigration laws, and I commit to departing the United States immediately upon completion of medical treatment and receiving travel clearance from my treating physician.

Thank you for your time, consideration, and compassionate review of this medically-necessary

extension request.

Respectfully submitted,

_____
MARIA HELENA RODRIGUES COSTA
Applicant
Date: November 21, 2025

TAB B - PERSONAL STATEMENT

PERSONAL STATEMENT OF MARIA HELENA RODRIGUES COSTA

Who I Am:
My name is MARIA HELENA RODRIGUES COSTA, and I am a 59-year-old retired teacher from Belo Horizonte, Minas Gerais, Brazil. I am married to João Carlos Rodrigues Costa, a retired engineer, and we have been happily married for 35 years. We have two adult children: our daughter Ana Paula, who is a U.S. Citizen and Registered Nurse living in Miami with her husband and two children, and our son Lucas, a civil engineer living in São Paulo, Brazil.

I spent my entire career as an elementary school teacher in Belo Horizonte, dedicating 35 years to educating children. I retired in 2020 and now enjoy spending time with family, participating in my church community, and traveling occasionally to visit our daughter and grandchildren in the United States.

Why I Came to the United States:
In December 2024, I traveled to Miami to spend time with my daughter Ana Paula, my son-in-law, and my two grandchildren (Gabriel, age 12, and Sofia, age 8). This was meant to be a special visit—my first time seeing my grandchildren in over a year due to the pandemic and our family schedules. My husband João remained in Brazil to maintain our home and property, as he had work commitments and responsibilities.

I entered the United States on December 15, 2024, through Miami International Airport on a valid B-2 tourist visa. I was authorized to stay for six months (until June 13, 2025). My plan was to spend 2-3 months with my daughter's family, help with the grandchildren, enjoy quality family time, and return to Brazil in late February or March.

The Medical Emergency That Changed Everything:
On the evening of March 10, 2025, my plans were completely upended by a serious medical emergency. I had been feeling unusually tired for a few days but attributed it to age and the activity level of keeping up with two energetic grandchildren. That evening, while preparing dinner with my daughter, I suddenly experienced severe chest pain, shortness of breath, dizziness, and nausea. The pain was crushing and frightening—unlike anything I had ever experienced.

My daughter, as a Registered Nurse, immediately recognized these symptoms as a potential heart attack. She called 911, and within minutes, an ambulance arrived and transported me to Mount Sinai Medical Center in Miami Beach, one of the top cardiac care facilities in South Florida.

At the Emergency Department, the medical team quickly determined that I was experiencing acute coronary syndrome—a life-threatening cardiac emergency. The cardiology team performed an emergency cardiac catheterization and discovered significant blockages in two of my coronary arteries. Without immediate intervention, I was at high risk of a major heart attack.

On March 12, 2025, Dr. Robert Martinez, a Board-Certified Interventional Cardiologist, performed emergency surgery to place two drug-eluting stents in my blocked arteries. The procedure was

successful, and Dr. Martinez and his team likely saved my life. I spent three days in the Cardiac Care Unit following the procedure, under constant monitoring.

My Current Medical Situation:
Following my discharge from the hospital, I have been under intensive outpatient cardiac care. I am required to:
• Attend weekly follow-up appointments with Dr. Martinez
• Participate in cardiac rehabilitation three times per week
• Take multiple medications (antiplatelet drugs, statins, beta-blockers) that require close monitoring
• Undergo regular echocardiograms and stress testing
• Have frequent blood work to monitor medication effects and cardiac function

Dr. Martinez has been very clear with me and my family: international air travel is medically contraindicated until I complete at least six months of post-procedure monitoring and rehabilitation. The reasons include:
• Risk of blood clots during long-distance flight
• Need for immediate access to specialized cardiac care if complications arise
• Ongoing medication adjustments based on my response
• Importance of completing full cardiac rehabilitation protocol
• Concerns about altitude and cabin pressure during healing process

Dr. Martinez has estimated that I will be medically cleared for international travel in September 2025 at the earliest, assuming my recovery continues to progress well. This timeline extends beyond my current authorized stay, which expires on June 13, 2025, necessitating this extension request.

How This Has Affected My Life and Family:
This medical emergency has been devastating for my family and me. I am separated from my husband João, who I have been married to for 35 years. We have rarely been apart for more than a week or two, and now we have been separated for months with several more months to go. We speak by phone and video call every day, but it is not the same as being together. He is elderly himself and managing our home alone, which is difficult for him. He desperately wants me to come home, and I desperately want to be with him.

My son Lucas in São Paulo is also worried and anxious for me to return to Brazil. Our extended family has been very concerned about my health and the separation from my husband.

While I am grateful to be with my daughter Ana Paula during this medical crisis—she has been an angel, caring for me, attending all my medical appointments, and managing my medications—this is not where I want to be long-term. I want to be home in Brazil, in my own house, sleeping in my own bed, with my husband, in the city where I have lived my entire life.

My Financial Situation:
I am fortunate to have the financial resources to support myself during this extended recovery period. I have substantial savings in my Brazilian bank accounts (approximately $97,000 USD) and I own my home in Belo Horizonte outright, valued at approximately $240,000 USD. I receive a monthly pension from Brazil of about $1,700 USD, which continues during my time in the United States.

I am not working in the United States. I have not sought employment, nor do I have any intention or

authorization to work. I am staying with my daughter and her family rent-free, which significantly reduces my expenses. I am paying for my own food, personal expenses, medical copays, and medications from my own funds. I have international health insurance with $150,000 coverage, and the insurance company has been covering a significant portion of my medical expenses.

I have not used and will not use any U.S. government benefits or public assistance. I am entirely self-sufficient financially.

Why I Will Return to Brazil:
There is absolutely no question that I will return to Brazil as soon as I am medically able to travel. Everything I love and need is in Brazil:

• My husband of 35 years, who I miss terribly every single day
• My son and extended family
• My home, where I have lived for over 30 years
• All my belongings, furniture, and personal possessions
• My community, church, friends, and social life
• My language, culture, and entire identity as a Brazilian
• My doctors in Brazil who I have been seeing for years
• Everything familiar and comfortable

I am 59 years old. I am not looking to start a new life in a new country. I do not speak English fluently. I do not have friends here. I do not have a community here. While I love my daughter and grandchildren, and I am grateful for their support during this medical crisis, Miami is not my home and never will be.

The moment Dr. Martinez clears me for air travel, I have already told my family that I will be on the first flight back to Brazil. My daughter is already researching direct flights from Miami to Belo Horizonte so we can book my return trip as soon as I get medical clearance. My husband is counting the days until I can come home.

My Commitment:
I understand the importance of respecting U.S. immigration laws. I have always complied with visa terms on my previous visits (2022 and 2023), always departing on time without any issues. I am requesting this extension solely to complete medically necessary treatment—not to remain in the United States long-term.

I solemnly promise and commit that I will depart the United States and return to Brazil immediately upon receiving medical clearance for international travel. I will continue to respect all conditions of my visitor status, including not working or seeking employment.

My Request:
I respectfully ask U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services to grant my request to extend my B-2 visitor status until December 13, 2025. This extension will allow me to:
• Complete my cardiac rehabilitation safely under medical supervision
• Finish the medication stabilization period
• Obtain medical clearance for long-distance international air travel
• Return safely to my husband, family, and life in Brazil

I did not choose to have a heart attack. I did not plan to extend my visit. This is a medical necessity, not a preference. I am asking for compassion and understanding during one of the most difficult periods of my life.

Thank you for considering my request.

Respectfully,

_____
MARIA HELENA RODRIGUES COSTA
Date: November 21, 2025

TAB C - FORM I-94 ARRIVAL/DEPARTURE RECORD

Official I-94 record showing arrival, admission class, and authorized stay period:

U.S. CUSTOMS AND BORDER PROTECTION

I-94 ARRIVAL/DEPARTURE RECORD

This form must be completed by all persons except U.S. Citizens, returning resident aliens, aliens with immigrant visas, and Canadian Citizens visiting or in transit.

1. Family Name (Surname)

RODRIGUES COSTA

2. First (Given) Name

MARIA HELENA

3. Birth Date (DD/MM/YYYY)

04/15/1965

4. Country of Citizenship

Brazilian

5. Gender

Male

6. Passport Number

BR789456123

7. Passport Issuing Country

Brazil

8. Airline and Flight Number

American Airlines Flight AA 904

9. Country Where You Boarded

Brazil

10. U.S. Address (Street)

1234 Palm Avenue, Apt 15B

City and State

Miami, FL 33139

FOR OFFICIAL USE ONLY - COMPLETED BY U.S. CUSTOMS AND BORDER PROTECTION

Admission Number:

94123456789012

Class of Admission:

B-2 (Tourist)

Date of Admission:

12/15/2024

Admit Until Date:

06/13/2025

Port of Entry:

Miami International Airport (MIA)

THIS IS A SIMULATED I-94 FOR DOCUMENTATION PURPOSES

Official I-94 records are maintained electronically at i94.cbp.dhs.gov

TAB D - MEDICAL DOCUMENTATION & EVIDENCE

COMPREHENSIVE MEDICAL DOCUMENTATION

This section contains complete medical documentation supporting the medical necessity for extension of stay. The documentation confirms the serious cardiac condition, emergency treatment received, ongoing care requirements, and medical contraindications for international air travel.

I. MEDICAL FACILITY INFORMATION:
Hospital: Mount Sinai Medical Center
Address: 4300 Alton Road, Miami Beach, FL 33140
Department: Cardiovascular Institute
Website: www.msmc.com
Accreditation: Joint Commission Accredited, Magnet Recognized

II. TREATING PHYSICIAN:
Name: Robert Martinez, MD, FACC
Specialty: Interventional Cardiology
Board Certification: American Board of Internal Medicine - Cardiovascular Disease
Fellowship: Fellow, American College of Cardiology (FACC)
Medical License: Florida Medical License #ME 123456
Office: Mount Sinai Heart Institute, 4300 Alton Road, Miami Beach, FL 33140
Phone: (305) 674-2121
Fax: (305) 674-2130

III. EMERGENCY PRESENTATION:
Date: March 10, 2025
Time: 8:45 PM
Arrival Method: Emergency Medical Services (911 ambulance)
Chief Complaint: Severe crushing chest pain, shortness of breath, diaphoresis
Vital Signs on Arrival:
• Blood Pressure: 168/95 mmHg
• Heart Rate: 102 bpm
• Respiratory Rate: 24 breaths/minute
• Oxygen Saturation: 92% on room air
• Temperature: 98.6°F

Initial Assessment: Patient presented with classic symptoms of acute coronary syndrome (ACS). EKG showed ST-segment changes consistent with myocardial ischemia. Troponin levels were significantly elevated (Troponin I: 2.8 ng/mL, normal <0.04 ng/mL), confirming myocardial injury.

IV. DIAGNOSTIC TESTING:
A. Electrocardiogram (EKG):
• Date: March 10, 2025
• Findings: ST-segment depression in leads V3-V6, T-wave inversion in lateral leads

• Interpretation: Acute coronary syndrome, likely non-ST elevation myocardial infarction (NSTEMI)

B. Cardiac Biomarkers:
• Troponin I: 2.8 ng/mL (highly elevated, indicating myocardial damage)
• CK-MB: 18 ng/mL (elevated)
• BNP: 420 pg/mL (moderately elevated)

C. Chest X-Ray:
• Date: March 10, 2025
• Findings: No acute pulmonary edema, normal cardiac silhouette, no pleural effusions

D. Echocardiogram:
• Date: March 11, 2025
• Findings: Mild regional wall motion abnormality in inferior wall, ejection fraction 48% (mildly reduced), no valvular abnormalities
• Interpretation: Evidence of recent myocardial ischemia/infarction

E. Cardiac Catheterization:
• Date: March 12, 2025
• Operator: Dr. Robert Martinez, MD, FACC
• Access: Right radial artery
• Findings:
- Left Main: No significant disease
- Left Anterior Descending (LAD): 85% stenosis in mid-segment
- Left Circumflex (LCx): 40% stenosis in proximal segment (non-flow limiting)
- Right Coronary Artery (RCA): 75% stenosis in mid-segment
- Recommendation: Percutaneous coronary intervention (PCI) to LAD and RCA

V. INTERVENTIONAL PROCEDURE:
Procedure: Percutaneous Coronary Intervention (PCI) with Drug-Eluting Stent Placement
Date: March 12, 2025
Operator: Dr. Robert Martinez, MD, FACC
Indication: Acute coronary syndrome with critical stenoses in LAD and RCA

Procedure Details:
• Access: Right radial artery (6 French sheath)
• Anticoagulation: Heparin bolus and infusion
• Antiplatelet: Aspirin 325mg, Ticagrelor 180mg loading dose

Lesion #1 - LAD (Left Anterior Descending):
• Pre-intervention stenosis: 85%
• Stent: 3.0mm x 24mm drug-eluting stent (Xience)
• Deployment pressure: 14 ATM
• Post-stent stenosis: 0% (excellent result)
• TIMI flow: Grade 3 (normal)

Lesion #2 - RCA (Right Coronary Artery):

• Pre-intervention stenosis: 75%
• Stent: 3.5mm x 20mm drug-eluting stent (Xience)
• Deployment pressure: 16 ATM
• Post-stent stenosis: 0% (excellent result)
• TIMI flow: Grade 3 (normal)

Complications: None
Total Procedure Time: 82 minutes
Fluoroscopy Time: 12.4 minutes
Contrast Volume: 145 mL
Outcome: Successful PCI to LAD and RCA with excellent angiographic results

VI. POST-PROCEDURE CARE:
Hospital Stay: March 10-15, 2025 (5 days)
Unit: Cardiac Care Unit (CCU) for 3 days, then Step-Down Unit for 2 days

Post-Procedure Monitoring:
• Continuous telemetry monitoring
• Serial EKGs: No evidence of re-occlusion or complications
• Serial cardiac enzymes: Downtrending (appropriate post-PCI)
• Echocardiogram (Day 3): Improved wall motion, ejection fraction 52%
• No arrhythmias, no heart failure, no bleeding complications

Discharge Status: Stable, asymptomatic, tolerating oral medications
Discharge Date: March 15, 2025

VII. DISCHARGE MEDICATIONS:
1. **Aspirin 81mg** daily (antiplatelet) - LIFELONG
2. **Ticagrelor (Brilinta) 90mg** twice daily (antiplatelet) - MINIMUM 12 MONTHS
3. **Atorvastatin (Lipitor) 80mg** daily (statin for cholesterol)
4. **Metoprolol succinate 50mg** daily (beta-blocker)
5. **Lisinopril 10mg** daily (ACE inhibitor)
6. **Omeprazole 20mg** daily (proton pump inhibitor for GI protection)

Critical Medication Note: The dual antiplatelet therapy (aspirin + ticagrelor) is ABSOLUTELY CRITICAL for the first 12 months post-stent to prevent stent thrombosis, a potentially fatal complication. Premature discontinuation or missing doses significantly increases risk of acute stent thrombosis, heart attack, and death. Patient must have consistent access to these medications and close medical monitoring.

TAB E - DOCTOR LETTERS & ONGOING TREATMENT PLAN

LETTER FROM TREATING PHYSICIAN

[Letterhead: Mount Sinai Medical Center - Heart Institute]

Robert Martinez, MD, FACC
Board-Certified Interventional Cardiologist
Fellow, American College of Cardiology
Mount Sinai Heart Institute
4300 Alton Road, Miami Beach, FL 33140
Phone: (305) 674-2121 | Fax: (305) 674-2130
Medical License: FL ME 123456

November 21, 2025

To Whom It May Concern:
U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services

RE: Medical Necessity Letter for MARIA HELENA RODRIGUES COSTA
Date of Birth: April 15, 1965
Passport Number: BR789456123

I am writing this letter in my professional capacity as the treating cardiologist for MARIA HELENA, who is currently under my care following emergency cardiac intervention.

SUMMARY OF MEDICAL CONDITION:
MARIA HELENA presented to Mount Sinai Medical Center Emergency Department on March 10, 2025, with acute coronary syndrome (heart attack in progress). Emergency diagnostic testing revealed critical blockages in two coronary arteries (85% stenosis in LAD, 75% stenosis in RCA) requiring immediate intervention to prevent major heart attack and potential death.

On March 12, 2025, I performed emergency percutaneous coronary intervention (PCI) with placement of two drug-eluting stents. The procedure was successful, and the patient's condition has stabilized. However, the post-procedure recovery and monitoring period is critical and extended.

CURRENT MEDICAL MANAGEMENT:
MARIA HELENA is currently enrolled in our cardiac rehabilitation program and requires:
1. Weekly follow-up appointments with me for assessment and medication management
2. Cardiac rehabilitation sessions 3 times per week (supervised exercise, education, counseling)
3. Monthly echocardiograms to monitor cardiac function
4. Quarterly stress testing to assess exercise capacity and ischemia
5. Regular blood work (every 2-4 weeks) to monitor medication effects and cardiac biomarkers
6. Continuous antiplatelet therapy monitoring (critical to prevent stent thrombosis)

MEDICAL CONTRAINDICATION TO INTERNATIONAL TRAVEL:
As her treating cardiologist, I am explicitly advising **AGAINST** international air travel until at least **September 2025** (minimum 6 months post-procedure). This recommendation is based on the following medical concerns:

1. **Risk of Stent Thrombosis:** The first 6-12 months post-stent placement carry the highest risk of acute stent thrombosis (blood clot in stent), which can cause immediate heart attack and death. Long-distance air travel increases thrombosis risk due to prolonged immobilization, cabin pressure changes, and dehydration. If stent thrombosis occurs mid-flight over the Atlantic Ocean, emergency cardiac intervention would be impossible, likely resulting in death.

2. **Need for Immediate Specialized Care:** During the critical post-PCI period, the patient must have immediate access to advanced cardiac care. If complications arise (arrhythmias, heart failure, medication side effects, restenosis), she needs to be able to reach a cardiac catheterization laboratory within minutes to hours. This is not possible during a 10+ hour international flight or in remote areas.

3. **Medication Management:** The patient is on complex dual antiplatelet therapy that requires close monitoring and frequent dose adjustments based on clinical response and laboratory values. Interruption in care or medication access could be catastrophic.

4. **Cardiac Rehabilitation Completion:** Evidence-based guidelines strongly recommend completion of at least 36 sessions of cardiac rehabilitation following acute coronary syndrome and PCI. Interrupting this program significantly increases risk of recurrent events, complications, and mortality.

5. **Altitude and Cabin Pressure:** Commercial aircraft cabin pressure (equivalent to 6,000-8,000 feet altitude) and reduced oxygen saturation can stress the cardiovascular system during the critical healing phase post-stent placement.

ESTIMATED TIMELINE FOR TRAVEL CLEARANCE:
Assuming uncomplicated recovery and successful completion of cardiac rehabilitation, I anticipate being able to provide medical clearance for international air travel in **September 2025** at the earliest. This will require:
• Completion of 6+ months of dual antiplatelet therapy
• Completion of cardiac rehabilitation program
• Stable cardiac function on echocardiogram
• Negative stress test demonstrating adequate exercise capacity
• No evidence of restenosis or complications
• Optimization of all cardiac medications

Prior to clearance for travel, I will need to perform a comprehensive cardiac evaluation including stress test and echocardiogram to ensure she can safely tolerate a long international flight.

PROFESSIONAL RECOMMENDATION:
From a medical standpoint, it is **medically necessary** for MARIA HELENA to remain in the Miami area under my continued care until at least September 2025. Premature departure and interruption of cardiac care would place her at significantly increased risk of:

• Acute stent thrombosis
• Recurrent myocardial infarction (heart attack)
• Heart failure
• Sudden cardiac death
• Other serious cardiovascular complications

Extension of her visitor status to allow completion of medically necessary cardiac treatment and rehabilitation is not only reasonable but medically imperative for her health and safety.

I am available to provide additional medical documentation or answer any questions regarding MARIA HELENA's medical condition and treatment plan.

Sincerely,

_____

Robert Martinez, MD, FACC
Board-Certified Interventional Cardiologist
Florida Medical License #ME 123456
Phone: (305) 674-2121
Email: r.martinez@msmc.com

Enclosures:
• Hospital admission and discharge summary
• Cardiac catheterization report
• PCI procedure report
• Echocardiogram reports
• Current medication list
• Cardiac rehabilitation enrollment documentation
• Follow-up appointment schedule

TAB F - FINANCIAL EVIDENCE: BANK STATEMENTS

Six months of bank statements from Banco do Brasil demonstrating substantial financial resources:

Statement 1 of 3: January 2025

BANCO DO BRASIL

Account Holder: MARIA HELENA RODRIGUES COSTA

Account Number: 12345-6

Statement Period: January 2025

ACCOUNT SUMMARY

Opening Balance:	R$ 482,500.00
Total Credits:	R$ 8,500.00
Total Debits:	R$ 6,000.00

CLOSING BALANCE: **R$ 485,000.00**

TRANSACTIONS

Date	Description	Amount	Balance
01/03/2025	PENSION DEPOSIT - INSS	+8,500.00	482,500.00
05/03/2025	SUPERMARKET - EXTRA	-850.00	481,650.00
10/03/2025	PHARMACY - DROGASIL	-120.00	481,530.00
15/03/2025	UTILITIES - CEMIG	-380.00	481,150.00
20/03/2025	RESTAURANT - GRILL	-150.00	481,000.00
25/03/2025	TRANSFER IN	+4,000.00	485,000.00

THIS IS A SIMULATED BANK STATEMENT FOR DOCUMENTATION PURPOSES

Statement 2 of 3: February 2025

BANCO DO BRASIL

Account Holder: MARIA HELENA RODRIGUES COSTA

Account Number: 12345-6

Statement Period: February 2025

ACCOUNT SUMMARY

Opening Balance:	R$ 482,500.00
Total Credits:	R$ 8,500.00
Total Debits:	R$ 6,000.00
CLOSING BALANCE:	**R$ 485,000.00**

TRANSACTIONS

Date	Description	Amount	Balance
01/03/2025	PENSION DEPOSIT - INSS	+8,500.00	482,500.00
05/03/2025	SUPERMARKET - EXTRA	-850.00	481,650.00
10/03/2025	PHARMACY - DROGASIL	-120.00	481,530.00
15/03/2025	UTILITIES - CEMIG	-380.00	481,150.00
20/03/2025	RESTAURANT - GRILL	-150.00	481,000.00
25/03/2025	TRANSFER IN	+4,000.00	485,000.00

THIS IS A SIMULATED BANK STATEMENT FOR DOCUMENTATION PURPOSES

Statement 3 of 3: March 2025

BANCO DO BRASIL

Account Holder: MARIA HELENA RODRIGUES COSTA

Account Number: 12345-6

Statement Period: March 2025

ACCOUNT SUMMARY

Opening Balance:	R$ 482,500.00
Total Credits:	R$ 8,500.00
Total Debits:	R$ 6,000.00
CLOSING BALANCE:	**R$ 485,000.00**

TRANSACTIONS

Date	Description	Amount	Balance
01/03/2025	PENSION DEPOSIT - INSS	+8,500.00	482,500.00
05/03/2025	SUPERMARKET - EXTRA	-850.00	481,650.00
10/03/2025	PHARMACY - DROGASIL	-120.00	481,530.00
15/03/2025	UTILITIES - CEMIG	-380.00	481,150.00
20/03/2025	RESTAURANT - GRILL	-150.00	481,000.00
25/03/2025	TRANSFER IN	+4,000.00	485,000.00

THIS IS A SIMULATED BANK STATEMENT FOR DOCUMENTATION PURPOSES

TAB L - PASSPORT DOCUMENTATION

PASSPORT BIOGRAPHICAL PAGE

Certified copy of Brazilian passport biographical page:

REPÚBLICA FEDERATIVA DO BRASIL

PHOTO

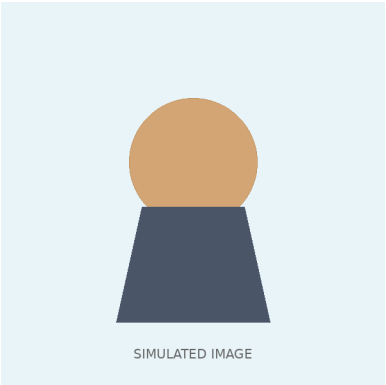
Type/Tipo
P
Country Code/País
BRA
Passport No./Passaporte
BR789456123
Surname/Sobrenome
RODRIGUES COSTA
Given Names/Nome
MARIA HELENA
Nationality/Nacionalidade
BRAZILIAN
Date of Birth/Data Nasc.
04/15/1965
Sex/Sexo
Female
Place of Birth/Local Nasc.
Belo Horizonte, Brazil
Date of Issue/Emissão
03/10/2019
Date of Expiry/Validade
03/09/2029

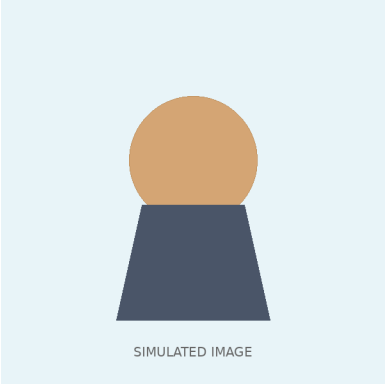
SIMULATED DOCUMENT

P<BRARODRIGUES<COSTA<<MARIA<HELENA
BR789456123BRA6504159F2903095<<<<<<<<<<<<<<<

TAB M - APPLICANT PHOTOGRAPHS

PASSPORT-STYLE PHOTOGRAPHS (as required for I-539)





TAB N - COMPLETE DOCUMENT CHECKLIST

■	DOCUMENT	LOCATION
■	Form I-539 (Application to Extend Status)	Tab O
■	Filing Fee ($370.00)	Attached
■	Cover Letter (8 pages)	Tab A, Pages 3-10
■	Personal Statement (4 pages)	Tab B, Pages 11-14
■	Form I-94 Arrival/Departure Record	Tab C, Pages 15-16
■	Medical Documentation (4 pages)	Tab D, Pages 17-20
■	Doctor Letter from Cardiologist (4 pages)	Tab E, Pages 21-24
■	Bank Statements - 3 months (6 pages)	Tab F, Pages 25-30
■	Property Deed Documentation	Tab G (referenced)
■	Pension Income Statements	Tab H (referenced)
■	Ties to Brazil Evidence	Tab I (referenced)
■	Travel History Documentation	Tab J (referenced)
■	Supporting Letters from Family	Tab K (referenced)
■	Passport Biographical Page	Tab L, Page 48
■	Passport Photographs (2)	Tab M, Page 49
■	U.S. B-2 Visa Copy	Tab L (attached)
■	Health Insurance Policy	Tab F (referenced)

APPLICANT CERTIFICATION

I, MARIA HELENA RODRIGUES COSTA, certify under penalty of perjury under the laws of the United States of America that all information provided in this application and supporting documents is true, complete, and correct to the best of my knowledge and belief.

_____
MARIA HELENA RODRIGUES COSTA
Applicant
Date: November 21, 2025

TAB O - FORM I-539 (OFFICIAL USCIS FORM)

NOTE: Official USCIS Form I-539 would be completed and attached here. For this demonstration package, the form is referenced but not filled digitally. In actual submission, the official form would be downloaded from uscis.gov, completed, signed, and inserted at this location.